

[Title — state the finding as a claim, not a topic]

Lessons from “[Exact Paper Title]” by [Authors] in [Journal], [Year].

[The core finding in one bold sentence.] [One or two sentences expanding on the finding and why it matters.]

BACKGROUND

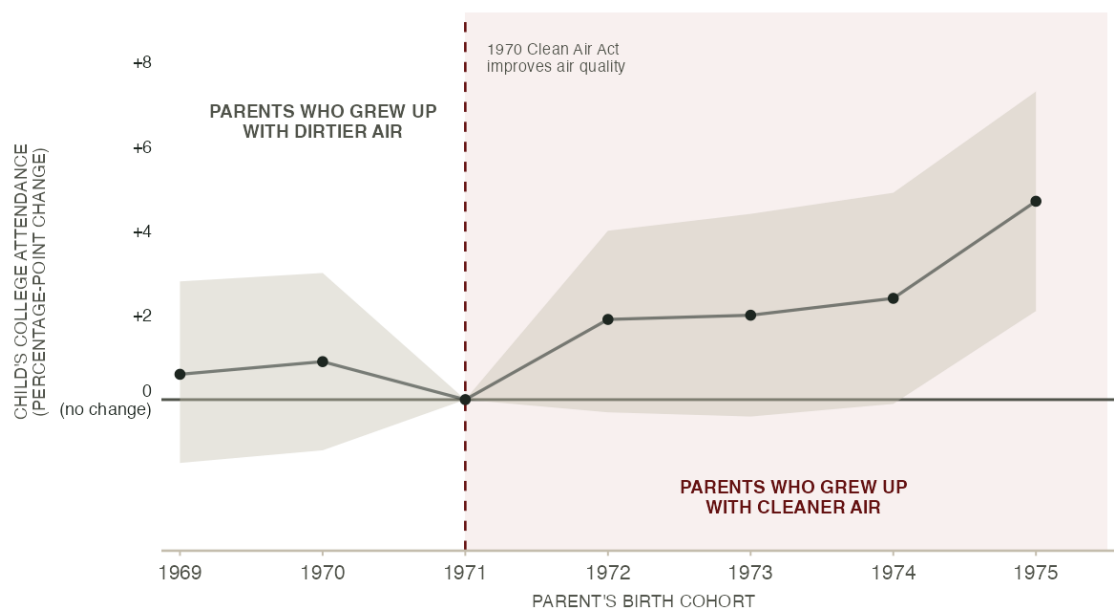
[Set up the policy problem. Define any key term on first use in **bold**, then explain it plainly. Spell out agencies on first mention. End on the open question the study tests.]

[Describe the setting and data in plain language — who was studied, what records the researchers had, and over what period.]

WHAT THE STUDY FOUND

[SENTENCE-STYLE FIGURE TITLE — WHAT THE CHART SHOWS]

Source: [Author(s)] ([Year]).



Environmental Inequality Lab · Early-Life Pollution Exposure, 2025

Note: Each point compares one parent's birth cohort with the 1971 cohort — how much more (or less) likely their children were to attend college. The line is flat before 1971 and climbs after the 1970 Clean Air Act cleared the air, so children of parents who grew up with cleaner air were increasingly likely to attend college. The shaded band shows the range of uncertainty, pinched to zero at the 1971 comparison year.

[Explain why the research design is credible — narrate the comparison, don't name the method. What would the result look like if the policy worked?]

[State the result, pointing the reader to the figure. End with the headline finding in **bold**.]

TAKEAWAYS

[SUBHEAD 1]

[First takeaway. Bold the one sentence someone skimming should catch.]

[SUBHEAD 2]

[Second takeaway.]

[SUBHEAD 3]

[Third takeaway. Acknowledge any caveats or limitations without getting too technical, then restate the central point.]

For more information, contact Jonathan Colmer (j.colmer@virginia.edu).

Colmer, Jonathan, and John Voorheis. Forthcoming. "The Intergenerational Effects of Early-Life Pollution Exposure." *Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics*. doi.org/10.1086/740104.